



AUT

Cover Letters & CV's

Tātai Pūmanawa

Employability & Careers



Workshop Outline

- ☐ Analysing a job advertisement & exploring how to tailor your Cover Letter to the job you are applying for
- ☐ Format & content for a Cover Letter
- ☐ Structure & content of a CV



Where are you at with writing your CV and Cover Letter?

- 1.** *I have never had a CV before or written a cover letter*
- 2.** *I've started my CV, but I need some help with it, as well as with writing a cover letter*
- 3.** *My CV is finished and I'm happy with my cover letter*



Cover letter



AUT Employer survey 2024

- 80% of employers want a cover letter
- They DO read them
- One-page is ideal in a business letter format
- 68% want it attached to an email, separate from the CV
- Salutations either Kia ora/ Ngā mihi nui OR Dear hiring manager/ Kind regards



Employer comments 2024

“Graduates tend to write very general cover letters that say nothing. This doesn’t help their application.”

“A cover letter that repeats what is in the CV is a waste of time.”

“look at the advertisement and identify what we are looking for and briefly explain the skills/attributes you have that fit with those requirements.”

“don’t use AI as it’s really obvious and doesn’t represent the real person.”



Employer comments 2024

“The key thing I want to read is why you are applying specifically for this role?”

“There is nothing nicer than receiving a cover letter where an applicant lets their personality come through”

“If you are ‘overqualified’ or changing fields tell me why you chose this role. If something is unusual explain if your situation is unusual i.e. I live in Auckland but grew up in Christchurch so that’s why I am relocating.”

Top tips for cover letters



Research the company. Why do you want to work for them? Know what they do!

Check company website. Do the company values align with yours? Tell them why you want to work for them!



Be authentic, show your personality.



Use AI with caution! Check spelling and grammar.



Job advertisement

What are the skills the employer is looking for?

What experience is the employer looking for?

What are the roles and responsibilities of the job and what experience do I have that matches?



Entry Level Customer Service Representative (Call Centre) - Inbound & Outbound

Wow customers with your natural ability to provide excellent customer service and technical skills!

About you:

A passion for providing exceptional customer service. Experience with automated customer service platforms and relevant business technology systems. Bring your resilience and strong ability to bounce back when encountering the challenges in the customer service industry.

We require experience working in a very fast-paced environment with a high attention to detail and multi-tasking skills. You will be a natural problem solver dedicated to resolving customer issues.

Ability to work independently and efficiently. Excellent written and verbal communication skills. Flexibility to adapt well to change.

About us

We are Foundever. We are a global company helping customers in 30 countries around the world 24/7. We add value through a people-first culture, operational excellence, knowledge sharing and collaboration, and global strength combined with local flexibility. Apply with cover letter and CV by 25 December

Job Advertisement Exercise

1. Read the advertisement provided on the previous screen for a Customer Service person.
2. Write down everything that appeals to you about this job e.g., what the purpose of the company is, the products they make, their values, location, environment, type of work, hours etc.
3. Write down the critical requirements and skills which the employer is looking for e.g., leaderships skills, teamwork, attention to detail.

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Cover letter content



Opening
paragraph

Summarise
what appeals
about working
for this
organisation

Outline the
critical
requirements
& skills the
employer
wants

Closing
paragraph



Format

Your address

Manukau, Auckland

Date

25 December 2025

Name of
company &
their address

Auckland University of Technology
Auckland 1010

Formal
greeting

Hi/Kia ora hiring manager,

Formal
closing

Kind regards,



Kia ora Hiring Manager,

I am excited to apply for the Entry-Level Customer Service Representative position for Foundever as advertised on Seek. I am passionate about providing exceptional customer service and am keen to work in a global company with a people-first culture, helping customers in 30 countries around the world.

I have recently completed the Bachelor of Business majoring in International Relations as I have always been interested in how the world is connected from a business perspective. As Foundever provides brands with comprehensive CX outsourcing services and solutions with operational excellence, I want to be a part of an organisation that not only cares for their customers but also encourages collaboration in their teams. Your values of creativity, commitment and connection resonate with me as I have always enjoyed the individual responsibility required with sports and academia in individual and group work. I am currently captain for the AUT netball team, member of three AUT clubs and have participated in many group projects at university.

I bring three years of customer service experience in a call center for a nationwide financial services company, where I consistently met or exceeded monthly call targets by 80%. My ability to resolve customer issues efficiently and my attention to detail were instrumental in providing clear, empathetic communication to clients. I also have experience working with automated customer service platforms in fast-paced environments, further honing my skills in delivering seamless customer interactions.

I look forward to hearing from you, to discuss what I offer and learn more about this opportunity.

Kind regards



Curriculum Vitae

How to structure your CV

- ☐ Contact information
- ☐ Introduction
- ☐ Skills Summary
- ☐ Education
- ☐ Work Experience
- ☐ Volunteering / Extracurricular activities/ Interests
- ☐ Achievements
- ☐ Referees

A CV is a marketing tool to help you get an interview

Contact Information



Name



Mobile number



Email address



Partial home address



LinkedIn URL

Career Objective or Career Summary Personal Statement

Example:

"My goal is to be a mechanical engineer working with large scale, technical machinery in a nationwide organisation. I am a recent graduate of AUT and offer 4 years part-time work at Bunnings where I've attained many transferable skills in customer service, problem solving and practical tool knowledge."

- ❑ Unique –Who are you? What do you want to do? What do you offer?
- ❑ Written in the first person i.e. "My and I am"
- ❑ Quick "snap-shot" of you & why you fit the role
- ❑ Specific to the role and size of organisation
- ❑ Draws attention to your key skills

Skills Summary

Transferable Skills

- Collaboration & teamwork – listening and communicating effectively with classmates through group projects
- Problem solving – able to analyse what has gone wrong and work out steps to solve the problem in part time roles
- Customer service – helping customers in my retail job with high quality service

Specialised/ Technical Skills

Programming Languages

- Advance JAVA
- Core PHP
- Python
- JavaScript
- C+

Database Languages

- Oracle 9i/10g/11g
- MS SQL server
- DBMS languages

Identify your skills: Book into workshop on elab.aut.ac.nz: 'Your Career Strengths'

Education

Bachelor of International Hospitality Management
Major Hospitality Enterprise & Minor Global Tourism
Auckland University of Technology (AUT)

Jul 2022 - Present

Key Papers:

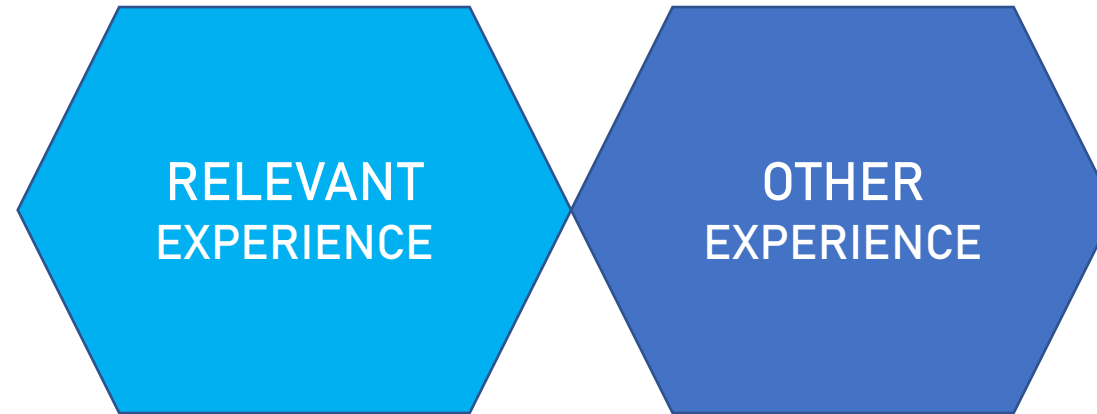
- Hospitality Innovation & Change
- Service Design Thinking
- Wellbeing in Tourism Destinations

Achievements:

- 2nd year Class Representative



Work Experience



Job Title

Month Year – Month Year

Company | Location (country international)

- Give a brief summary of your key responsibilities
- Highlight skills or accomplishments

Volunteering & Extra curricular



☐ Highlight transferable skills

☐ Gain practical experience

☐ Build new networks





Achievements & Interests

- ❑ Highlight personal achievements
- ❑ Employers want to know more about you
- ❑ Showcase your personality
- ❑ Other elements in your life = work/life balance

Referees



- ❑ “Referees available upon request”
- ❑ Employers have to ask your permission to contact referees at the end of the recruitment process so there is no need to put them in your CV

Next steps

The screenshot displays the AUT Employability & Careers website. The header features the 'EMPLOYABILITY & CAREERS' title and the AUT logo. A navigation bar includes links for 'Elab Online', 'MyElab', 'Appointments', 'Events', 'Resources', and 'Business Co-opt'. A user profile 'Barena' is logged in. The main content area includes a 'talenthub' banner with a 'go to AUT's own recruitment service' link, a 'FIND JOBS' section for searching internships and graduate programs, and a 'nzunitalent' logo. Below this is a navigation bar with 'EXPLORE', 'FOCUS', 'APPLY', and 'SORTED' tabs. A row of six circular icons represents career stages: 'CV & COVER LETTER', 'INTERVIEWS', 'JOB SEARCH', 'NETWORKING', 'CAREER DECISIONS', and 'YOUR BRAND'. The 'Take charge of your career' section features two award banners: 'AUT EDGE AWARD' and 'BEYOND AUT AWARD'. The bottom section contains three service tiles: 'EMAIL US' (Talk to an Employability Specialist), 'My CAREERLAB' (AUT logo), and 'BOOK IN' (To meet employers). The footer includes three interactive boxes: 'Online Interview Practice', 'LinkedIn Profile Check', and 'CV Drop Box', each with a corresponding image of students working.

EMPLOYABILITY & CAREERS

AUT

Elab Online - MyElab - Appointments - Events - Resources - Business Co-opt

22 Barena

talenthub

go to AUT's own recruitment service

FIND JOBS

Search for internships, graduate programmes, full time, part time, summer and voluntary work.

nzunitalent

EXPLORE > FOCUS > APPLY > SORTED

CV & COVER LETTER

INTERVIEWS

JOB SEARCH

NETWORKING

CAREER DECISIONS

YOUR BRAND

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AUT EDGE AWARD
ENHANCING YOUR EMPLOYABILITY

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